

SUCCESSFUL CONSULTING PROJECT COMPLETION RECOMMENDATION LETTER

In Lisbon, Portugal, November 30, 2025

I hereby confirm that **Disha Patel**, a student at the University of Massachusetts Lowell, Manning School of Business, successfully participated in the **"INTERNATIONAL EXPANSION STRATEGY FOR UNICORN FACTORY LISBOA"** Business Consulting Project.

The project engaged student teams to design a comprehensive international expansion strategy for Unicorn Factory Lisboa (UFL). Students delivered rigorous market and competitive analyses (including a structured SWOT), a global benchmark of up to nine relevant organizations with ten defined metrics and point-based scoring, and an evaluation of market expansion models (e.g., franchising, direct investment, partnerships, licensing).

Within this engagement, three complementary strategic journeys replaced the original single-track approach. First, a Luso-Brazilian bridge positions Lisbon and UFL as the de-risked European gateway for Brazilian innovation and, conversely, as the essential bridge for European entities entering Brazil, leveraging cultural affinity and existing policy frameworks. Second, an export of accelerator know-how monetizes UFL's proven methodology in smaller, high-need European markets through low-resource arrangements such as licensing or pay-for-performance. Third, vertical complementarity partnerships address capability gaps in high-value domains (e.g., Deep Tech and advanced B2B) by teaming with European players that bring specialized expertise or late-stage capital, while UFL contributes its Iberian pipeline, policy legitimacy, and talent.

Throughout the engagement, **Disha** demonstrated professionalism, analytical rigor, and clear communication. Her contributions were insightful and implementable, reflecting a solid grasp of international market dynamics and operational considerations.

From the client's perspective, the recommendations were highly actionable and grounded in operational realities. We were particularly impressed by the three proposed strategic journeys, and the team's work will serve as a strong foundation for our international expansion decisions.



Gil Azevedo
Executive Director
Unicorn Factory Lisboa



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